In subsequent years, Pakistan's security agencies killed IS activists in Lahore, Gujranwala, Sialkot, Karachi and so on.

Security experts were of the opinion that the threat from IS could mature into a reality if they succeeded in aligning themselves with the splinter groups of mainstream militants, including the TTP. This process was already taking place. The terrorist attack on Civil Hospital, Quetta, in August 2016, in which more than 70 people died and more than 100 people were injured, was believed to be the handiwork of IS and TTP. The state was taking time to respond to this new challenge as it was in a state of denial as usual. If the Pakistan security and intelligence forces did not respond to the emerging menace, it could be another major threat not only to Pakistan but also to the region.

The killing of TTP chiefs and its splintering could not be construed as the demise of TTP. Rather splintering suited to its survival as it became confusing for the intelligence agencies and LEAs to tackle more than 40 groups, all operating under the umbrella of TTP. Although the public reaction after the terrorist attack on the Army Public School, Peshawar, spurred the armed forces to annihilate the terrorists completely, the hydra could not be decimated to its final end. It did create a palpable dent in the command and control structure of the insurgents. But its leadership went into hiding along with a large number of fighters, using the strategic depth of Afghanistan, with the aim to fight back at the right time. They emulated the Afghan Taliban strategy against the US and Allied forces in Afghanistan. Moreover, the rollback of US forces from Afghanistan did not have diminishing effect on TTP's activities. Rather it got a better shelter in Afghanistan. All the facts and factors indicate that the demise of TTP and the end of terrorism might not happen any time soon.